



LAKEWOOD CITY COUNCIL MINUTES

Monday, April 20, 2026

City of Lakewood

6000 Main Street SW

Lakewood, WA 98499

<https://us02web.zoom.us/j/86872632373>

Dial +1(253) 215- 8782 Participant ID: 868 7263 2373

CALL TO ORDER

Mayor Bocchi called the meeting to order at 6:00 p.m.

ROLL CALL

Councilmembers Present: 7 – Mayor Paul Bocchi, Deputy Mayor Patti Belle, Councilmembers Ellen Talbo, Michael Brandstetter, Philip Lindholm, Ryan Pearson and J. Trestin Lauricella.

PLEDGE OF ALLEGIANCE

Mayor Bocchi led the Pledge of Allegiance.

PUBLIC COMMENTS

The City Council received written comments in advance of the meeting from Walli Roarke.

Tichomir Dunlop, Lakewood resident, requested the City support the lights out initiative, now through the end of May, to protect birds during migration.

Judith Anderson, Tacoma resident, requested that the City not allow Garry Oak trees to be cut down and in support of tree preservation.

Joel Vrana, Eagle Point Homeowners Association, shared a petition from residents, expressed concerns about the water quality on American Lake and requested use of the City's permit to treat the water.

Joel Vrana, Lakewood resident, expressed concerns about the algae blooms and water quality on American Lake.

Rick Wilkerson, asked questions regarding crime levels, park access, public health issues and boating specific to the proposed park on Gravelly Lake.

Barb Tucci, Gravelly Lake Improvement Club, spoke about emergency access to Gravelly Lake and in opposition to increasing public access to Gravelly Lake.

Curtis Clemons, Lakewood resident, spoke in opposition to increasing public access to Gravelly Lake due to the size of the lake.

David Clark, Lakewood resident, spoke in opposition to increasing public access to Gravelly Lake due to security concerns.

James Dunlop, Lakewood resident, spoke about the vote to increase sales tax for criminal justice purposes and bureaucratic bias.

Christina Manetti, Lakewood resident, spoke about Earth Day on April 22nd, the City's decision not to recognize it but rather recognize Parks Appreciation Day and requested Earth Day be recognized in future years.

Christina Manetti, Garry Oak Coalition, spoke in opposition to increasing pavement and concrete throughout the city due to the impacts to trees and in support of de pave models and education to residents regarding impervious surfaces.

Hailey Ivey, Lakewood resident, expressed concerns for lakes and spoke about the Edgewater Park Master Plan public hearing process.

Brett Jacobson, Lakewood resident, spoke about the property at Hilltop Lane being considered for public access to Gravelly Lake and requested the Council review the feasibility for proceeding.

Dan Hodgson, Lakewood resident, spoke about residents parking vehicles on the street in the Tillicum neighborhood which prevents emergency access to neighborhood and in opposition to cannabis and tiny homes in the city.

Kris Kaufmann, Lakewood resident, spoke about lakes throughout the city, Gravelly Lake being non-navigable lake, and in opposition to increased access to Gravelly Lake.

C O N S E N T A G E N D A

- A. Approval of the minutes of the City Council meeting of April 6, 2026.
- B. Motion No. 2026-27

Authorizing the execution of necessary agreements with the Six Remnant Defendants related to the National Opioid Settlement.

C. Motion No. 2026-28

Authorizing the execution of an amendment to the agreement with FACET NW, in the amount of \$50,000, for street-end design services for the Westlake Street End Project.

D. Motion No. 2026-29

Authorizing the execution of an agreement with Salish Construction Company, in the amount of \$324,808, for the street light installation project.

E. Motion No. 2026-30

Authorizing the execution of an amendment to the agreement with EXP US Services, in the amount of \$137,515, to reflect state climate change grant funding.

F. Motion No. 2026-31

Authorizing the execution of an amendment to the agreement with Pacific Point Defense, in the amount of \$86,000, for public defense services.

G. Items filed in the Office of the City Clerk:

1. Lakewood's Promise Advisory Board meeting minutes of March 5, 2026.
2. Lakewood Arts Commission meeting minutes of March 9, 2026.
3. Planning Commission meeting minutes of March 18, 2026.

COUNCILMEMBER PEARSON MOVED TO ADOPT THE CONSENT AGENDA. SECONDED BY COUNCILMEMBER LINDHOLM. VOICE VOTE WAS TAKEN AND CARRIED UNANIMOUSLY.

R E G U L A R A G E N D A

PUBLIC HEARINGS AND APPEALS

This is the date set for a public hearing on the FY 2026 Community Development Block Grant (CDBG) Annual Action Plan for CDBG and HOME Programs.

There being no public testimony, the public hearing was declared closed at 6:56 p.m.

ORDINANCE**Ordinance No. 849 Amending Lakewood Municipal Code Chapter 5.60 related to Rental Housing Licensing and Inspection Requirements. – continued from April 6, 2026**

A POINT OF ORDER WAS RAISED BY COUNCILMEMBER BRANDSTETTER REGARDING CHANGES TO ORDINANCE NO. 849 FROM WHAT WAS PRESENTED ON APRIL 6, 2026 AND APRIL 20, 2026. MAYOR BOCCHI SUSTAINED THE POINT OF ORDER.

COUNCILMEMBER BRANDSTETTER REQUESTED ORDINANCE NO. 849, AS PRESENTED ON APRIL 6, 2026 BE FURTHER CONTINUED TO THE CITY COUNCIL MEETING OF MAY 4, 2026. SECONDED BY DEPUTY MAYOR BELLE. VOICE VOTE WAS TAKEN AND CARRIED UNANIMOUSLY.

RESOLUTION**Resolution No. 2026-01 Amending the City's Purchasing Policies.**

COUNCILMEMBER BRANDSTETTER MOVED TO ADOPT RESOLUTION NO. 2026-01. SECONDED BY COUNCILMEMBER PEARSON.

COUNCILMEMBER PEARSON MOVED CONTINUE CONSIDERATION OF RESOLUTION NO. 2026-01 TO THE MAY 4, 2026 CITY COUNCIL MEETING. SECONDED BY COUNCILMEMBER TALBO. VOICE VOTE WAS TAKEN AND CARRIED UNANIMOUSLY.

UNFINISHED BUSINESS

None.

NEW BUSINESS

None.

ITEMS FOR DISCUSSION**Review of 1st Quarter (2026) Police Report.**

Chief Patrick Smith provided an overview of calls for service, arrests, crimes against persons, property and society, pursuits, eluding, shots fired, motor vehicle thefts and collisions for 1st Quarter (2026) noting that there are continued reductions in crime rates. Discussion ensued.

Review of 2025 Transportation Benefit District Annual Report.

Deputy City Manager Tho provided an overview of Transportation Benefit District projects completed in 2025. She shared that this will come forward for approval at the City Council meeting of May 4, 2026.

Review of 2025 Year-End Financial Report.

Deputy City Manager Tho Kraus provided an overview of activity in all funds as of December 31, 2026. Discussion ensued.

Review of 2026 Carry Forward Budget Adjustment.

Deputy City Manager Tho Kraus provided an overview of the 2026 Carry Forward Budget Adjustment highlighting the new funding requests in the general and street funds. She shared that a public hearing will be held at the City Council meeting of May 4th. Discussion ensued.

REPORTS BY THE CITY MANAGER

City Manager Russell thanked the City Council for their continuation of items on the agenda for this evening.

He then announced the following upcoming meetings and events:

- April 21, 3:00 P.M., BECU Neighborhood Financial Center Ribbon Cutting Ceremony
- April 21, 7:00 P.M., Fort Steilacoom Neighborhood Association
- April 23, 6:00 P.M., Downtown Neighborhood Association
- April 25, 9:00 A.M., Parks Appreciation Day
- April 25, 12:00 P.M., Wards Lake Park Ribbon Cutting Ceremony

The City Council requested an update on the water quality issue on American Lake and follow up regarding residents' concerns related to the American Lake – Lake Management District.

CITY COUNCIL COMMENTS

Councilmember Lauricella spoke about the Retreat and asked the City Council whether they would be interested in meeting on the 4th Monday of the month, quarterly. He shared that his week he will attend an Earth Day event, Downtown Neighborhood Association, Park Appreciation Day, the Wards Lake Park Ribbon Cutting and the Opioid Abatement

Council meeting. He requested an update from the Municipal Court which will be scheduled for a future Council meeting. He then spoke about public access to Gravelly Lake and shared that he looks forward to opportunities for continued discussion on this topic.

Councilmember Pearson requested follow-up to the public comments regarding parking on public streets in Tillicum. He shared that this week he will attend the Master Builders Association Housing Summit.

Councilmember Lindholm shared that he will attend the Master Builders Association Housing Summit.

Councilmember Brandstetter shared that he will attend the Master Builders Association Housing Summit and spoke about the public comments around access to Gravelly Lake and water quality on American Lake. He wished safe travels to those who are traveling to Sister City, Gimhae and spoke about the Artist Reception held this evening highlighting Korean artists.

Councilmember Talbo thanked the Mobile Home Village Park for allowing parking during the Wards Lake Park Grand Opening Celebration, shared that she attended the Planning Commission meeting, she supports adding additional meetings on the 4th Monday of each month when there is a 5th Monday and spoke about the development of street ends. She shared that she plans to attend the Master Builders Association Housing Summit and the Fort Steilacoom Neighborhood Association.

Deputy Mayor Belle spoke about the reopening of Nyanza Road following the street and sidewalk improvements.

Mayor Bocchi spoke about the history of parks development projects, and he requested the City Council provide feedback on a draft letter to Sound Transit to advocate for ST3 implementation and expansion. After discussion, the City Council supports sending a letter.

ADJOURNMENT

There being no further business, the meeting adjourned at 9:33 p.m.



PAUL BOCCHI, MAYOR

ATTEST:



BRIANA SCHUMACHER
CITY CLERK